

P. pseudoaureum. See *Phlebodium pseudoaureum*.
P. vulgare (Common polypody, Polypody) illus. p.291. ‘**Cornubiense**’ see *P. x mantoniae* ‘Cornubiense’. ‘**Cristatum**’ is an evergreen, creeping fern. H and S 10–12in (25–30cm). Narrowly lance-shaped, divided, mid-green fronds, with semipendulous, terminal crests, grow from creeping rhizomes covered with copper-brown scales. **subsp. serratum** see *P. cambricum*. Z3–6

POLYSCIAS

ARALIACEAE

Genus of evergreen trees and shrubs, grown for their foliage. Sometimes has insignificant flowers in summer, but only on large, mature specimens. Frost tender. Needs partial shade and humus-rich, well-drained soil. Water containerized plants freely when in full growth, moderately at other times. Straggly stems may be cut out in spring. Propagate by seed in spring or by stem-tip or leafless stem-section cuttings in summer. Red spider mite may be a problem.
P. filicifolia (Fern-leaf aralia) illus. p.458. ‘**Marginata**’ is an evergreen, erect, sparsely branched shrub. H 6–8ft (2–2.5m) or more, S 3ft (1m) or more. Has 1ft (30cm) long leaves with many small, ovate to lance-shaped, serrated, bright green leaflets with white edges. Z12 (min. 61°F/16°C)
P. guilfoylei (Geranium aralia). Slow-growing, evergreen, rounded tree. H 12–20ft (4–6m), S 3–8ft (1–2.5m) or more. Leaves are 10–16in (25–40cm) long and divided into ovate to rounded, serrated, deep green leaflets. Z12 (min. 61°F/16°C). ‘**Victoriae**’ (Lace aralia) illus. p.458.

POLYSPORA

THEACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs and trees, grown for their flowers and overall appearance. Frost hardy to half hardy. Prefers sun or partial shade and humus-rich, acidic soil. Water potted plants moderately, less in winter. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in late summer or by seed when ripe, in fall, or in spring.
P. axillaris, syn. *Gordonia axillaris*. Evergreen, bushy shrub or tree. H 10–12ft (3–4m), S 6–10ft (2–3m), sometimes much more. Has lance-shaped, leathery, glossy leaves, each with a blunt tip, and bears, from fall to spring, saucer-shaped, white flowers. Z9–11

POLYSTICHUM

DRYOPTERIDACEAE

Genus of usually evergreen, sometimes semievergreen or deciduous ferns. Fully hardy to frost tender. Prefers partial shade and moist, but well-drained soil enriched with fibrous organic matter. Remove faded fronds regularly. Propagate species by division in spring or by spores in summer, selected forms by division in spring.

P. acrostichoides. Evergreen fern. H 1½ft (45cm), S 3ft (90cm). Slender, lance-shaped, deep green fronds have small, hollylike pinnae. Excellent for cutting. Z3–9

P. aculeatum (Hard shield fern, Prickly shield fern). Evergreen fern. H 2ft (60cm), S 3ft (90cm). Broadly lance-shaped, yellowish-green, then deep green fronds, with oblong to ovate, spiny-edged, glossy pinnae, are produced on stems often covered in brown scales. Z4–8
P. braunii. Evergreen or semievergreen fern. H 16–32in (40–80cm), S 3ft (90cm). Produces a rosette of spreading to arching, lance-shaped, divided, dark green fronds, to 2ft (60cm) long. Young fronds are densely covered with orange-brown scales when unfurling in spring. Z3–8
P. munitum (Giant holly fern) illus. p.293.
P. polyblepharum (Japanese tassel fern). Evergreen fern. H 24–32in (60–80cm), S 3ft (90cm). Produces “shuttlecocks” of spreading, lance-shaped, divided, shiny, dark green fronds, 12–32in (30–80cm) long, covered with golden hairs when they unfurl. Pinnae lobes are oblong-ovate and have spiny-toothed margins. Z5–8
P. rigens. Evergreen fern. H 16in (40cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has “shuttlecocks” of narrowly ovate-oblong, divided, leathery, harsh-textured, dull green fronds, 1–1½ft (30–45cm) long. Broad, lance-shaped pinnae are divided into ovate, spiny-toothed lobes. Fronds are yellowish-green in spring. Z5–6
P. setiferum (Soft shield fern).
Divisilobum Group illus. p.291.
Plumosodivisilobum Group illus. p.291.
‘Pulcherrimum Bevis’ illus p.290.
P. tsussimense illus. p.292.

Poncirus trifoliata. See *Citrus trifoliata*.

PONTERDERIA

PONTERDERIACEAE

Genus of deciduous, perennial, marginal water plants, grown for their foliage and flower spikes. Fully to frost hardy. Needs full sun and up to 9in (23cm) depth of water. Remove fading flowers regularly. Propagate in spring by division or by seed.
P. cordata (Pickerel weed) illus. p.441.

POPULUS

SALICACEAE

Genus of mainly deciduous trees, grown for their habit, foliage, and very quick growth. Produces catkins in late winter or spring. Female trees produce copious amounts of fluffy, white seeds. Fully hardy. Prefers full sun and needs deep, fertile, moist, but well-drained soil; resents dry soil, apart from *P. alba*, which thrives in coastal gardens. Extensive root systems can undermine foundations, so poplars are unsuitable for planting close to buildings, particularly on clay soil. Propagate by hardwood cuttings in winter. Susceptible to bacterial canker and fungal diseases.
P. alba (Abele, White poplar) illus. p.60. Much confused with the commoner *P. x canescens*. ‘**Raket**’ (syn. *P.a. Rocket*) is a narrowly conical, deciduous tree. H 70–130ft (20–40m), S 25ft (8m). Has white, hairy new shoots and ovate to rounded, wavy-margined to maplelike, 5-lobed leaves, dark green above, white-hairy beneath, that turn yellow in fall. In early

spring, bears red, male or green, female catkins. Leaves of ‘**Richardii**’, H 40ft (12m), S 25ft (8m), are golden-yellow above. **ROCKET** see *P.a. Raket*. Z3–9
P. balsamifera (Balsam poplar, Tacamahac). Fast-growing, deciduous, upright tree. H 100ft (30m), S 25ft (8m). Has smooth shoots and ovate, glossy, dark green leaves, whitish beneath, strongly balsam-scented when young. In early spring, bears pendent, green catkins. Z3–9
P. x canadensis (Canadian poplar). Fast-growing, conical to columnar, deciduous tree. H 80–120ft (25–35m), S 50–80ft (15–25m). Triangular to ovate, scalloped, glossy, bright green leaves turn yellow in fall. In early spring, bears red male or green female catkins. ‘**Aurea**’ (Golden poplar), H 80ft (25m), S 30ft (10m), has golden-yellow leaves in late spring and early summer, later turning yellowish-green. ‘**Robusta**’ illus. p.62. Z4–9
P. x candicans of gardens. See *P. x jackii*.
P. x canescens (Grey poplar) illus. p.60.
P. deltoides (Eastern cottonwood, Necklace poplar). Very fast-growing, deciduous, spreading tree. H 100ft (30m), S 70ft (20m). Has lush growth of broadly ovate to triangular, glossy, bright green leaves. In early spring, bears red male or green female catkins. Z4–9
P. x jackii, syn. *P. x candicans* of gardens (Balm of Gilead, Ontario poplar). Very fast-growing, deciduous, conical tree. H 80ft (25m), S 50ft (15m). Ovate leaves are dark green and, when young, balsam-scented. Bears green female catkins in early spring. Very susceptible to canker. Z3–9.
‘Aurora’, H 50ft (15m) or more, S 20ft (6m), has leaves that are heavily but irregularly blotched creamy-white.
P. lasiocarpa (Chinese necklace poplar). Very fast-growing, deciduous, spreading tree. H 70ft (20m), S 40ft (12m). Has stout shoots and very large, heart-shaped, mid-green leaves with red veins, on long, red stalks. Bears stout, drooping, yellow catkins in spring. Z6–9
P. maximowiczii illus. p.61.
P. nigra (Black poplar). Fast-growing, deciduous, spreading tree. H 120ft (35m), S 70ft (20m). Has dark bark. Diamond-shaped, bronze young leaves turn bright green, then yellow in fall. Male trees bear red catkins in mid-spring. Z3–9.
‘Italica’ (Lombardy poplar) illus. p.63.
P. szechuanica. Very fast-growing, deciduous, conical tree. H to 130ft (40m), S 30ft (10m). Has flaking, pinkish-gray bark and large, heart-shaped, dark green leaves, whitish-green beneath, bronze when young. Bears red male or green female catkins in mid-spring. Z5–9
P. tremula (Common aspen). Vigorous, deciduous, spreading tree. H 70ft (20m), S 30ft (10m). Rounded leaves are bronzed when young, gray-green when mature, and yellow in fall. Flattened stalks make foliage tremble and rattle in wind. In early spring, bears gray-red male or green female catkins. Z2–5. ‘**Erecta**’, S 5–10ft (1.5–3m), has an upright habit. ‘**Pendula**’ (Weeping aspen) illus. p.74.
P. trichocarpa (Black cottonwood, Western balsam poplar). Very fast-growing, deciduous, conical tree. H 100ft (30m) or more, S 30ft (10m). Has dense growth of

ovate, glossy, dark green leaves with green-veined, white undersides, strongly balsam-scented when young. Foliage turns yellow in fall. In mid-spring, bears red male or green female catkins. Z4–8

PORANA

CONVOLVULACEAE

Genus of evergreen or deciduous, twining climbers, grown for their flowers. Frost tender. Provide full light and fertile, moisture-retentive, well-drained soil. Water freely in full growth, sparingly in cold weather. Stems require support. Thin out evergreen species and cut back deciduous ones to just above ground level in late winter or early spring. Propagate by basal, softwood cuttings in late spring or early summer or by seed in spring.
P. paniculata (Bridal bouquet, Snow creeper). Vigorous, evergreen, twining climber. H 20–30ft (6–10m). Leaves are heart-shaped. Large, loose panicles of small, elder-scented, trumpet-shaped, white flowers are borne from late summer to midwinter. Z10–12 (min. 41°F/5°C)

PORTULACA

PORTULACACEAE

Genus of fleshy annuals and a few perennials with showy, cup-shaped, roseline flowers that open in sun and close in shade. Half hardy to frost tender. Needs full light and any well-drained soil. Grow as annuals in a sunny, dry border or in a container. Propagate by seed sown under glass in early spring, or outdoors in late spring. Prone to attack by aphids.
P. grandiflora (Rose moss, sun plant). Slow-growing, partially prostrate annual. H 4–8in (10–20cm), S 6in (15cm). Has lance-shaped, succulent, bright green leaves. In summer, produces shallowly bowl-shaped flowers, 1in (2.5cm) across, with conspicuous stamens, in shades of yellow, red, pink, or white. Z10–11. **Happy Hour Series** are branching, with semidouble flowers in a wide range of colors. Flower well during shorter days. **Happy Hour Series ‘Peppermint’** has mottled, pink flowers. **Happy Trails Series**, H 6–9in (15–23cm), S 14–18in (35–45cm), are spreading, and bear semidouble flowers in a wide range of hues, including white, pink, yellow, orange, and red. **Lazy Daze Mixture** are low-growing, dense, and semitrailing, with double flowers in many colors. Good in hanging baskets or as temporary groundcover.

PORTULACARIA

DIDIEREACEAE/PORTULACACEAE

Genus of evergreen or semievergreen, succulent-leaved shrubs, grown for their foliage. Frost tender. Needs full sun and well-drained soil. Water potted plants moderately when in full growth, less at other times. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer.
P. afra (Elephant bush) illus. p.457.
f. foliis-variegatis see *P.a. ‘Variegata’*. ‘**Variegata**’ (syn. *P.a. f. foliis-variegatis*) is an evergreen or semievergreen, erect shrub with more or less horizontal